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RETURN

Create Ukraine Programme Launches URC 2026 Call for Global Talent Return

KSE Foundation's Create Ukraine programme has opened a new competitive call inviting Ukrainian professionals worldwide to return home and contribute to reconstruction. The initiative matches international expertise with Ukraine's sectoral needs, offering structured reintegration pathways for diaspora members.

3R: Direct flagship Return mechanism: provides a concrete, funded programme architecture for diaspora reactivation aligned with reconstruction priorities — a replicable model for scaling.

KSE FOUNDATION

IOM URC 2026 Takeaways: Diaspora Engagement Requires Trust, Not Just Incentives

IOM's URC 2026 session on diaspora engagement concluded that return cannot be driven by financial incentives alone — rebuilding institutional trust, ensuring safety guarantees, and creating meaningful employment are preconditions. Recommendations include diaspora advisory councils and phased return pilots.

3R: Reframes Return strategy: shifts focus from transactional incentives to trust-building infrastructure — critical for designing effective diaspora reactivation policy beyond programme announcements.

IOM UKRAINE

53% of Ukrainian EU Migrants Intend to Return — But 66% Remain Undecided on Timing

Gradus Research survey data shared at URC 2026 shows 53% of Ukrainian migrants in the EU intend to return, 31% do not, and 66% cannot specify when. The intention-action gap is driven by security uncertainty, lack of housing, and absence of comparable employment opportunities in Ukraine.

3R: Quantifies the Return opportunity and its barriers: the 53% pool represents millions of potential returnees — but policy must address the 66% timing uncertainty to convert intent into action.

GRADUS / LINKEDIN

1.5–2 Million Young Ukrainians Abroad: Youth Leadership Pipeline for Return

Razom for Ukraine highlights that between 1.5 and 2 million young Ukrainians currently live abroad due to the war. A cohort of 30 young leaders from across the EU, Switzerland, and the US attended URC 2026, signalling organised efforts to keep youth connected to Ukraine's recovery agenda and create pathways for eventual return.

3R: Identifies the youth Return cohort as a distinct strategic priority: young diaspora members are both most at risk of permanent emigration and most valuable for long-term reconstruction — requiring dedicated engagement programming.

RAZOM FOR UKRAINE / FACEBOOK

RECRUIT

ILO Local Employment Partnerships in Mykolaiv & Odesa: Demand-Driven Skilling at Scale

ILO's Local Employment Partnerships (LEPs) in Mykolaiv and Odesa operate as demand-driven skilling hubs, directly aligning training curricula with employer needs through upskilling and reskilling programmes. The model integrates social dialogue development to ensure labour market relevance and employer co-investment in workforce development.

3R: Provides a proven Recruit infrastructure model: LEPs demonstrate how to close skill gaps in war-affected regions through employer-led training — directly scalable to other Ukrainian oblasts facing reconstruction workforce shortages.

ILO

ILO LEP National Report: Employer-Led Training and Vocational Education Reform as Recruitment Engine

The ILO's broader LEP action report documents employer-led training, reskilling initiatives, and vocational education curriculum updates deployed across Ukrainian regions. The programme demonstrates that structured public-private partnerships can systematically recruit and retrain displaced workers into priority reconstruction sectors.

3R: Scales the Recruit model nationally: documents replicable mechanisms for converting displaced labour supply into skilled workforce demand — essential for reconstruction human capital planning.

ILO

Healthcare Talent Recruitment: Ukraine Trains Maxillofacial Surgeons and Health Managers at URC 2026

Ukraine's Ministry of Health showcased URC 2026 partnerships delivering educational programmes for maxillofacial surgeons and healthcare managers, alongside 3D technology integration in clinical practice. These initiatives address critical skill gaps created by war casualties and medical professional emigration.

3R: Healthcare is the most acute Recruit sector: war has simultaneously increased medical demand and depleted supply — targeted specialist training programmes are the fastest pathway to closing critical healthcare workforce gaps.

MINISTRY OF HEALTH OF UKRAINE

RETAIN

Women's Employment as Retention Lever: Economic Impact of Integrating Inactive Female Labour

VoxUkraine research demonstrates that providing retraining and employment opportunities to unemployed and economically inactive Ukrainian women generates significant GDP impact. The study frames female labour force participation as both an economic necessity and a retention mechanism — employed women are significantly less likely to permanently emigrate.

3R: Reframes Retain policy for the largest underutilised cohort: women represent Ukraine's single largest untapped labour reserve — investing in their employment simultaneously addresses skill gaps and reduces emigration pressure.

VOXUKRAINE

Prime Minister at URC 2026: Resilience Narrative as Retention Signal

Ukraine's Prime Minister used the URC 2026 platform to deliver a public message of resilience — 'We Fight, We Suffer, We Stay Resilient' — directly addressing both international partners and Ukrainians abroad. The messaging strategy is designed to sustain national identity cohesion and signal long-term state viability as a factor in retention decision-making.

3R: Retain requires narrative infrastructure: government signalling of state stability and purpose is a documented factor in diaspora return/stay decisions — this messaging contributes to the psychological dimension of retention.

INSTAGRAM / URC 2026

Ukrainian Immigrant Population in the US: Post-2022 Growth and Policy Implications

Migration Policy Institute data shows the Ukrainian immigrant population in the United States grew significantly following Russia's 2022 full-scale invasion, creating a substantial North American diaspora node beyond the traditional EU focus. This population represents a Return and Recruit resource pool that Ukrainian human capital policy has yet to systematically address.

3R: Expands the geographic scope of Return/Recruit strategy: the US Ukrainian community is underserved by current diaspora engagement programmes — mapping and activating this pool should be a near-term policy priority.

MIGRATION POLICY INSTITUTE
